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tech

REVIEWS

ViewSonic XG2431 Gaming Monitor

Say goodbye to blurring

Gaming monitors with a refresh rate of 240 Hz aren't a rarity anymore. In fact, you can get one for as low as ₹20K which is a huge reduction from just three years ago. Moreover, display manufacturers have, more or less, moved past chasing a higher refresh rate figure. The human eye finds it difficult to perceive the difference between refresh rates north of 240 Hz so aside from a few outliers who've come out with 480 Hz monitors, manufacturers have started improving the quality of the panels. The ViewSonic XG2431 is one such attempt.

Blur Busters, a popular website among monitor enthusiasts, has been coming up with innovative tests to help enthusiasts see the differences in how monitor technologies have been implemented. And they have established a standard for some of the key parameters that affect motion blur on monitors. The XG2431 from ViewSonic is the first monitor to live up to their latest Blur Busters 2.0 standard.

BUILD QUALITY

Out of the box, the ViewSonic XG2431 might not seem all that impressive. It's still a 24-inch 240 Hz monitor which is what we have been seeing since the first 240 Hz monitor made its way into the Digit Test Centre, six years ago.

The XG2431 has a clean and simple design with really thin bezels on the sides and the top, and a slightly thicker chin on the bottom. The LED indicator lights aren't that bright and distracting. The base is quite wide and the monitor stem is attached to the base via a swivel mechanism with gradations for folks who want accuracy with their adjustments. Speaking of tilting, there is a -5 / + 15 degree tilt which is sufficient for most installations. Also, the monitor pivots to the right by 90 degrees.

Then there's a height adjustment of 120 mm and along the back of the step there is also a path to route cables. At



the top of the step, there's a pull out mechanism for hanging headsets. One thing that ViewSonic seems to have missed out on is to have a little handle at the top of the stem.

Lastly, we have the panel which is by Innolux and has a matte finish on the viewing surface which helps when viewing content with darker shades with illumination on the back of the viewer. There's also native FreeSync and G-SYNC support making this a great candidate for high FPS gaming.

PERFORMANCE

On to the performance part. The monitor records a brightness of about 330 cd/m³ which is very good in this price segment. And the monitor also has DisplayHDR 400 certification so with HDR turned on we have seen a luminance of around 500 cd/m³. The panel boasts of a contrast ratio of 1000:1 and in our tests we recorded 900:1 which is close to spec but in this price bracket, we've seen several monitors with 3000:1 contrast ratio. The XG2431 also doesn't have any local dimming feature so we can't get darker blacks. Both the above factors

play a huge role in the colour reproduction and we saw a deltaE of 0.7 post calibration. That's also a very good figure for a high refresh rate panel. When we checked out the viewing angles, the colours didn't appear that washed out from the sides. Vertically, the colour washout is much more prominent. Then again, monitors aren't viewed from such angles.

Gaming performance is next. We can't repeat this enough, but if you are using a high refresh rate monitor, always use a DP cable if you want the full colour depth.

HDMI will only give 144 Hz if the panel is set to 10-bit. FPS games running on the RX 6900 XT experienced no tearing at all with FreeSync enabled. Lastly, in the ghosting test we can see very little ghosting thanks to the tuning done by the Blur Busters folks. The results

are very similar to NVIDIA's ULMB, and that's saying a lot.

VERDICT

The XG2431 sits right in the midst of all the 240 Hz monitors in terms of pricing but the value added in terms of the well-tuned Blur Reduction technology make the monitor one of the better 240 Hz panels we've seen. The contrast ratio could have been better but if you're a gamer who likes to have the lights turned off while gaming, this is a great pick.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL: IPS | SCREEN SIZE: 24-inches | RESOLUTION: 1920 x 1080 | REFRESH RATE: 240 Hz | CONNECTORS: 2x HDMI 2.0, DP 1.4 | AUDIO PASSTHROUGH: Yes | CONTRAST RATIO: 1000:1 | RESPONSE TIME: 0.5ms (GTG) | POWER: 23 W | WEIGHT: 6.8 kg.

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